

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

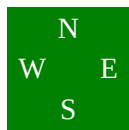
♠ 9 7
 ♥ A K 10 4 2
 ♦ J 6 4 2
 ♣ Q 9

♠ 4 3 2

♥ 9 5 3

♦ A K 9 5

♣ 7 4 2



♠ 8 6 5

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q 10 3

♣ J 10 8 5

♠ A K Q J 10

♥ Q J

♦ 8 7

♣ A K 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

Suppose you ruff the third ♥, pull just two rounds of trumps, then play ♣ A K 3. No good. The defender with the ♣s will take that trick and play his last trump, stopping dummy from the ♣ ruff.

But this way will work. Ruff the third ♥ and duck a ♣! Win any return and now pull two rounds of trumps. Then play ♣ A K 6, ruffing the ♣6 with dummy's last trump. The rest of the tricks are yours.

In Deal 14 you had pretty much a sure thing. Here you had to be extremely lucky with the opposing cards.

But you also had to be extremely clever to pull it off. This is probably the hardest Deal in this section.

This is identical to Deal 14 except dummy has the ♠4 in place of the ♠9. South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♥A, then the ♥K, then ♥10.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

The 2 ♥s are already lost, so you put your mind to the 2 ♣s. If the suit splits 3-3 the problem goes away, but a 4-2 split is more likely. So you should plan to ruff the fourth ♣ in dummy.

You cannot use the same method that worked in Deal 14 because with this hand when you ruffed the fourth ♣ with dummy's ♠4 it would surely get over-ruffed. This time you are going to have to be very lucky and find the defender with only two ♣s to also have only two ♠s.

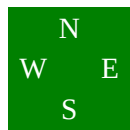
Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2



♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
their ♠A, their 2 ♣s and their ♦A.

South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

The ♣ lead was terrible for you as it exposes your 2 ♣ losers before you can establish a ♦ for a discard. If you start to pull trumps now the defense will grab their ♠A, their 2 ♣s and their ♦A.

If you try to establish a ♦ they will do the same thing, just in a different order. What does that leave you?

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

The ♣ lead was terrible for you as it exposes your 2 ♣ losers before you can establish a ♦ for a discard. If you start to pull trumps now the defense will grab

If you try to establish a ♦ they will do the same thing, just in a different order. What does that leave you?

It leaves you trying the only possible way you can make this contract, finessing East for the ♥Q to get a ♣ discard from dummy.

You win the ♣A in dummy, play the ♥K, then return a ♥ to your ♥J. You then discard a ♣ from dummy on the ♥A.

When you have only one chance to make your contract you take it.

This time it worked, another time it might not.